

REVIEW



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Change the Diapers Now

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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND

The EV Pickup Returns



OFF DUTY

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What's
News

Business & Finance

◆ **Michelle Bowman**, the Fed's vice chair of supervision, spoke at an invitation-only, private dinner that Bank of America hosted for clients in New York hours after the central bank announced its latest policy decision. **A2**

◆ **Google turned to Nvidia's** playbook to build a rival artificial-intelligence-chip business, offering financial guarantees to encourage data centers to use its products. **A1**

◆ **Charles Schwab** broke into the prediction markets, working with Cboe Global to roll out options contracts for wagers on the performance of the S&P 500. **B9**

◆ **Reformation**, the fast-growing womenswear retailer popular among celebrities, is getting ready to go public as soon as this summer. **B9**

◆ **Deluxe**, one of the largest paper-check producers, acquired payment-processing company Celero Commerce for \$625 million in cash. **B9**

◆ **Chinese autonomous-driving** company Momenta's valuation reached around \$9 billion as it gears up for a listing in Hong Kong. **B9**

◆ **Tech and digital** services company Jio Platforms will file for an initial public offering in India, the chairman of its parent company, Reliance Industries, said. **B10**

Worldwide

◆ **Strikes by Israel** against the Iran-backed militant group Hezbollah marked one of the most serious escalations in Lebanon since a ceasefire in April and threatened to derail talks between the U.S. and Iran aimed at cementing a 60-day ceasefire agreement. **A1, A7, B10**

◆ **The Supreme Court** ruled that Congress can't automatically forbid all users of illegal drugs from having guns, further expanding the scope of the Second Amendment right to bear arms. **A3**

◆ **The DHS is expected** to scrap plans to convert seven warehouses purchased as part of a \$38 billion program under then-Secretary Kristi Noem to immigration-detention centers. **A3**

◆ **The architects of California's** proposed billionaire tax said they were open to withdrawing the ballot measure if Gov. Gavin Newsom supports a smaller wealth tax. **A4**

◆ **Italy's right-wing** Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni accused Trump of fabrication after he told Italian media she had "begged" for a photo with him at the G-7 summit. **A6**

◆ **Luigi Mangione's** defense team said they no longer intended to present a psychiatric defense at his New York state-court murder trial. **A6**

◆ **Died: James Burrows**, 85, prolific sitcom director. **A6**

PEGGY NOONAN
Can 'we the people' survive the AI revolution? **A13**

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U.S. Soccer Wins Again, Beating Australia 2-0



HEADS UP: Alex Freeman scored the U.S. team's second goal Friday in Seattle as it notched its second win in as many matches in the World Cup, outscoring its opponents 6-1. The win guarantees the U.S. advances to the knockout round. **A10**

Google Uses Nvidia's Playbook To Build a Rival for AI Chips

By ROBBIE WHELAN
AND KATHERINE BLUNT

Google is making an ambitious play for a bigger slice of the 21st century's most important market: the chips that power artificial intelligence. Its financial might and years of technical development put it in prime position to succeed.

One obstacle it has had to contend with: tech companies' fear of crossing Jensen Huang, Nvidia's uberterritorial chief executive.

On the southern shore of Lake Ontario, a short drive from Niagara Falls, Google has been demonstrating how it can use Nvidia's playbook to win customers.

The site in western New York is host to an AI data-center cluster known as Lake Mariner. Alphabet-owned Google has provided a \$3.2 billion financial guarantee for the project, whose developers will rent the computing power from thousands of its microprocessors to AI giant Anthropic, according to people familiar with the matter.

It is the same strategy Nvidia has used to stoke already-blazing demand for its own AI chips.

Until recently, Nvidia all but had that market to itself, its graphics processing units, or GPUs, coveted by tech companies for their power to train and run AI models. As the AI race has morphed into a contest for computing resources, challengers have edged in—none more formidable than

Google.

"You have all these very well-capitalized companies who are big believers that this market around compute is going to have tremendous value," said Nazar Khan, co-founder and chief technology officer of the AI infrastructure company TeraWulf, which is developing Lake Mariner with FluidStack, a Google-backed cloud provider. "They want to be in the game, they don't want to be left behind."

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Crazy Rich Returns Lure All To Red-Hot Asian Markets

Global success of AI-related companies in South Korea, Taiwan and Japan stokes market fever

Na Se-bin has lost all sense of the value of money.

Since January, she has poured nearly all her life savings, roughly \$47,000, into the stock market, lured by a global AI boom enriching tech powerhouses in South Korea, Taiwan and Japan.

By Jiyoung Sohn, Joyu Wang
and Junko Fukutome

Riding wild market swings, the 24-year-old South Korean software developer said she has won and lost the equivalent of a month's salary in the span of a second. Despite the risk, she can't resist—not after seeing some of her holdings double in price. Over the past 18

months, South Korea has been the world's top-performing stock market, and Na and her co-workers joke they should sell their underwear to buy more shares.

"Even friends who have never touched stocks are getting into it," Na said. "Everyone's doing something."

Trillions of dollars are flowing into AI's global build-out, which relies on semiconductors and chip-making technology from a handful of Asian exporters. The worldwide surge in chip demand is swelling exports, corporate profits and the bank accounts of many investors, seemingly without end.

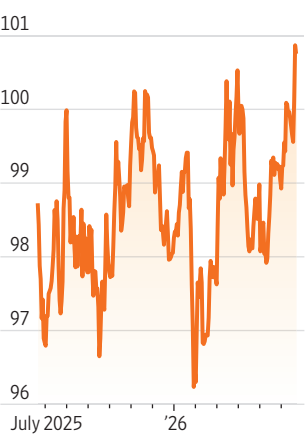
Even after recent pullbacks, Taiwan's main stock market has doubled in value over the

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Dollar Sets One-Year High

The currency was boosted by rate-hike expectations. **B10**

U.S. Dollar index over the past year



Note: A measure of the dollar against a basket of currencies
Source: FactSet

Lebanon Clashes Reignite Mideast Tensions

Renewed fighting between Israel and Hezbollah delays U.S. talks with Tehran

TEL AVIV—Strikes by Israel against the Iran-backed militant group Hezbollah marked one of the most serious escalations in Lebanon since a ceasefire in April and threatened to derail talks between the U.S. and Iran aimed at cementing a 60-day ceasefire agreement reached this past week.

By Feliz Solomon,
Benoit Faucon
and Lara Seligman

Israel and Hezbollah on Friday agreed to renew a ceasefire after the new flare-up, U.S. and Israeli officials said. Strikes had mostly subsided on Friday, but some clashes continued after the fresh ceasefire took effect at 4 p.m. local time, a U.S. official said.

In the fighting overnight into Friday, Israel's military said that four of its soldiers

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- ◆ **Iran's early access to cash** takes shape..... **A7**
- ◆ **Global economy will take** time to recover..... **A7**

Trump's Moves Test His Grip On GOP

President Trump has delivered the same retort to political allies who have offered him strategic advice in recent weeks, according to people with knowledge of the conversations: "I'm the president and you're not."

By Brian Schwartz,
Natalie Andrews
and Alexander Ward

Seventeen months into his second term, Trump is increasingly relying on his own gut instincts, dismissing the counsel of aides, conservative lawmakers and longtime associates. The result has been a series of decisions that have confounded and frustrated Republicans—heightening fears that voters will punish the GOP in the Nov.

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- ◆ **Trump claim draws ire of** Italy's Meloni..... **A6**

Wealthiest Classes Voice Economic Angst

By AARON ZITNER

America's economic anxiety is rising up the income ladder.

A new Wall Street Journal poll finds that even those who consider themselves among the wealthiest classes in America carry high levels of concern about their current finances, the years ahead and the prospects for their children.

More than 40% of Americans who call themselves upper class or upper-middle class say they lack confidence that life for their kids will be better than

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nancial security is where they thought it would be at this point in their lives. Nearly 3 in 5 say they are strained by high gasoline prices.

Those in the wealthiest classes have lost faith that an economy that has benefited them can lift future generations. Some 86% of people who call themselves upper class or upper-middle class say they lack confidence that life for their kids will be better than

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- ◆ **New Fed chief's first task** is to assess AI boom..... **A2**

EXCHANGE



INTO THE SPOTLIGHT
Secretive Wall Street powerhouse Jane Street seeks to become a major AI investor. **B1**

Everyone in Trump's Cabinet Is Eating Sauerkraut

JD Vance, RFK Jr. and other officials swear by diet of grass-fed meat and fermented foods

By NATALIE ANDREWS
AND LIZ ESSLEY WHYTE

A new diet is sweeping through President Trump's cabinet—and it involves heaping portions of sauerkraut.

Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy and Vice President JD Vance have all embraced the diet, drawn by the promise of slimmer waistlines and glowing

skin.

They all apparently have determined the health benefits outweigh the slightly sulfurous odors that have been the cause of some domestic friction.

"Within 30 days I lost 20 pounds," Kennedy said at an event in Michigan this week. "JD Vance is also on the diet and you can see how different he looks."

The diet is the brainchild of Dr. Sean O'Mara, who advises

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